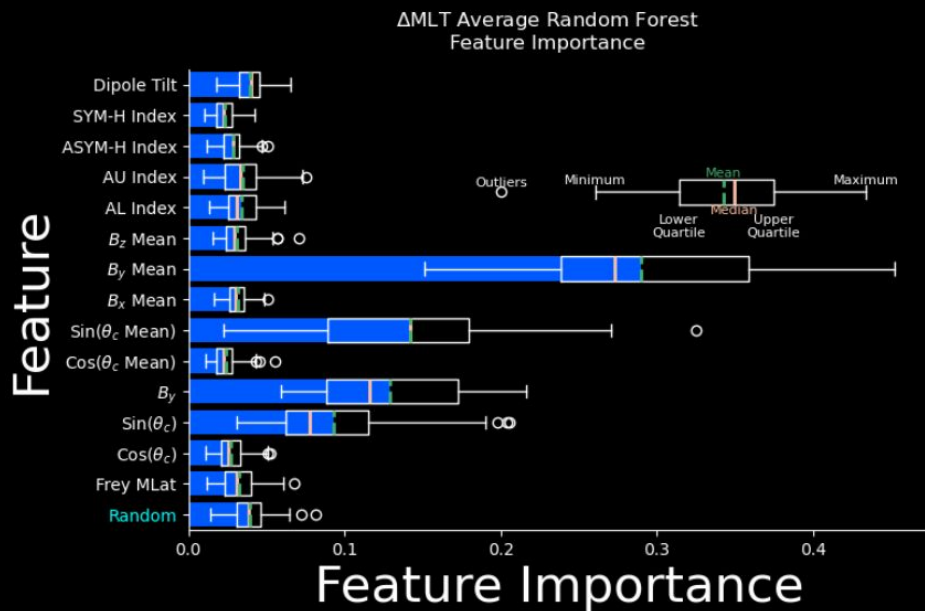


Decision Trees and Feature Importance



Decision Trees

- **Decision Tree**
- Root node
- Child node
- Left node
- Right node
- **Features**
- **Samples**
- **Target Variable**



Experiment



100 Students took a test

What we know:

- **Hrs studied**
- **Hrs slept**
- **Attendance Rate**
- **Previous Exam Score**
- **Age**
- **Pass/Fail**

What we want to know:

1. Which factor contributes most to whether a student passes?
2. If another student took the test, based on the prior knowledge, will they pass or fail?

Decision Trees

- **5 Features** Hrs studied, Hrs slept, Attendance Rate, Previous Exam Score, Age
- **Target Variable** Pass/Fail
- **100 Samples** Students



Decision Trees

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**



Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

Hrs studied, Hrs slept, Attendance Rate, Previous Exam Score, Age



Root Node

100 Samples

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Decision Trees

Hrs studied, Hrs slept, Attendance Rate, Previous Exam Score, Age



Root Node

100 Samples

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Decision Trees

Loop through Hrs slept, Attendance Rate, Age

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

Hrs slept (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Test each unique
value as a threshold

Root Node

100 Samples

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Decision Trees

Hrs slept (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Threshold

$x < 1$, $x \geq 1$

Left | Right

How well split are
pass and fail?

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

Hrs slept (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Threshold

$x < 10$, $x \geq 10$

Left | Right

How well split are
pass and fail?

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

Hrs slept (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Threshold

$x < 6$, $x \geq 6$

Left | Right

How well split are
pass and fail?

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

Hrs slept (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Threshold

$x < 3$, $x \geq 3$

Left | Right

How well split are
pass and fail?

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

Hrs slept (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Threshold

$x < \dots$, $x \geq \dots$

Left | Right

How well split are
pass and fail?

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

Attendance Rate (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Threshold

$x < \dots$, $x \geq \dots$

Left | Right

How well split are
pass and fail?

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

Age (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Threshold

$x < \dots$, $x \geq \dots$

Left | Right

How well split are
pass and fail?

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

List of Impurity
Reduction Values

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Which one is best?

Hrs Slept

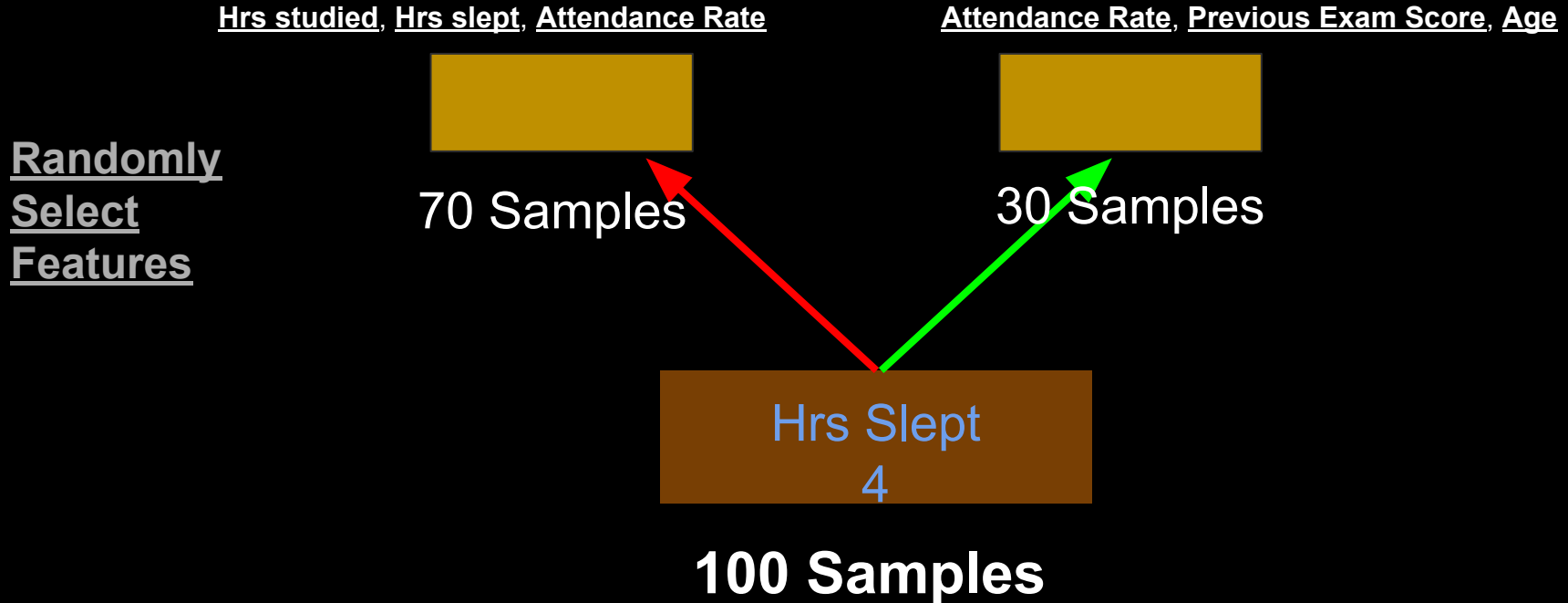
Hrs Slept
4

100 Samples

Decision Trees



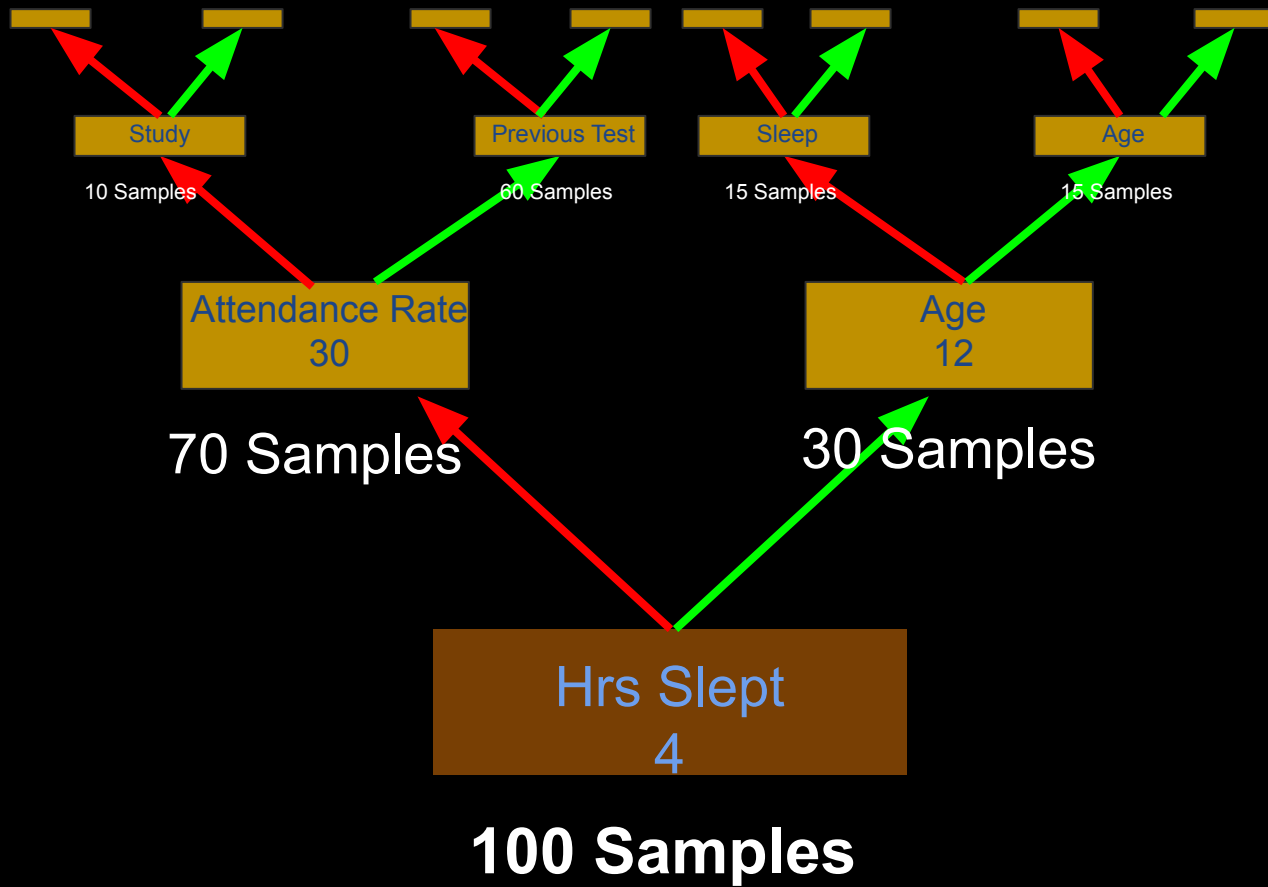
Decision Trees



Decision Trees







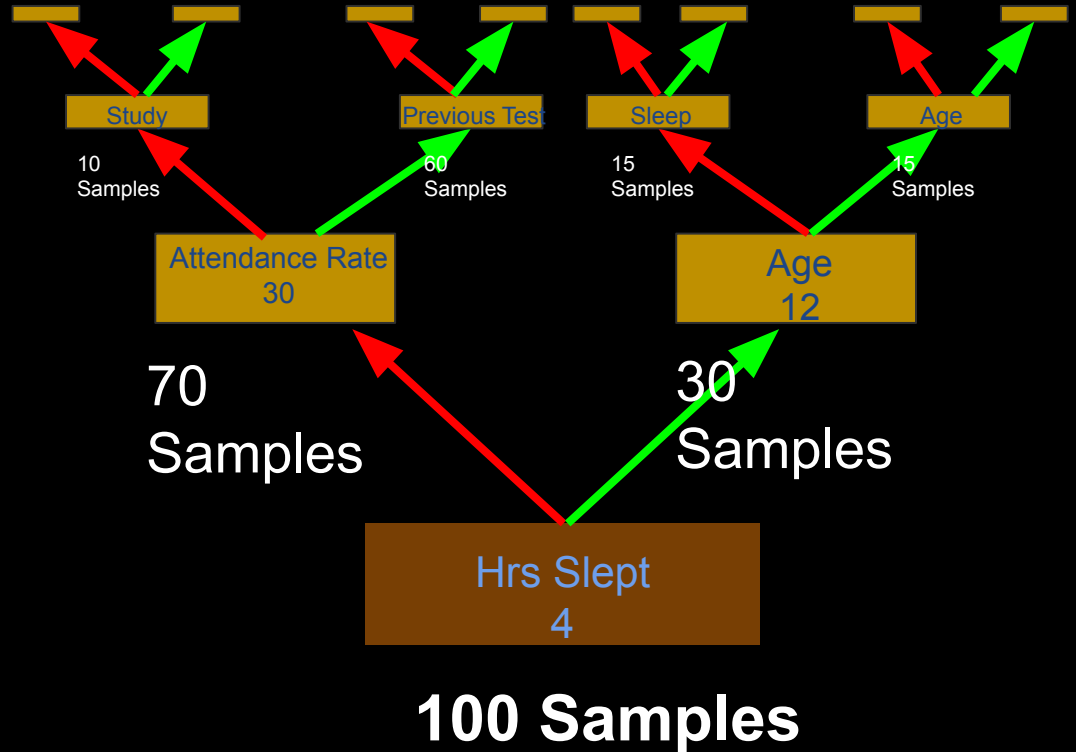
Decision Trees

- **Decision Tree**
- Root node
- Child node
- Left node
- Right node
- **Features**
- **Samples**
- **Target Variable**



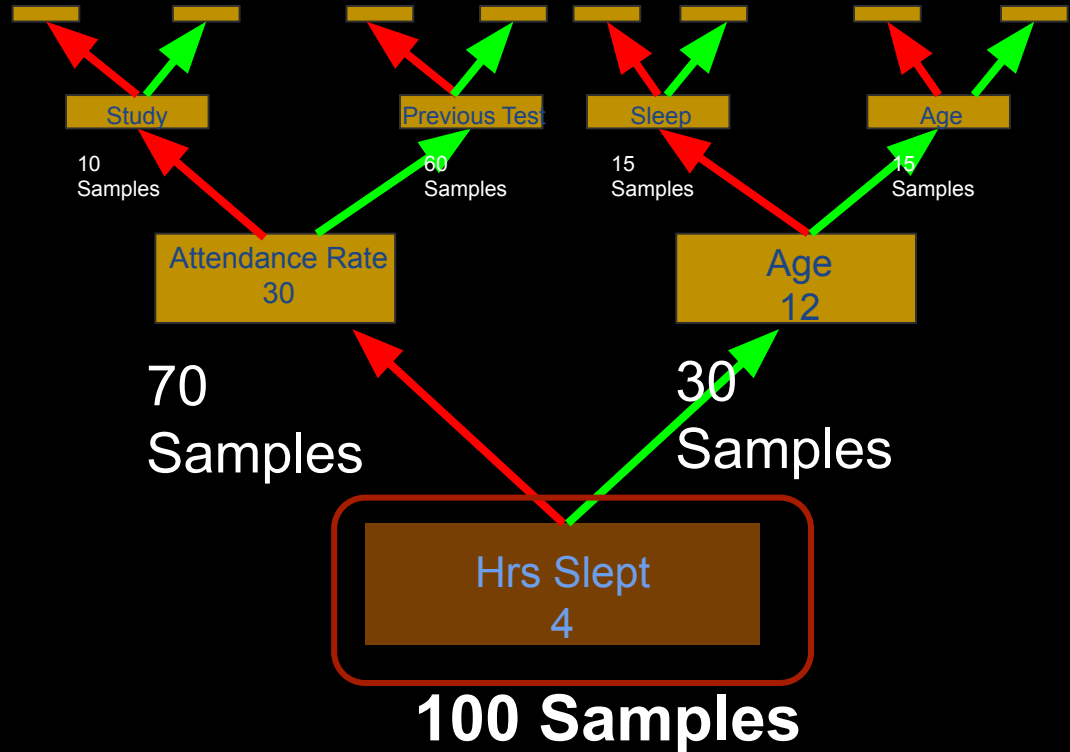
Decision Trees

- **Decision Tree**
- Root node
- Child node
- Left node
- Right node
- **Features**
- **Samples**
- **Target Variable**



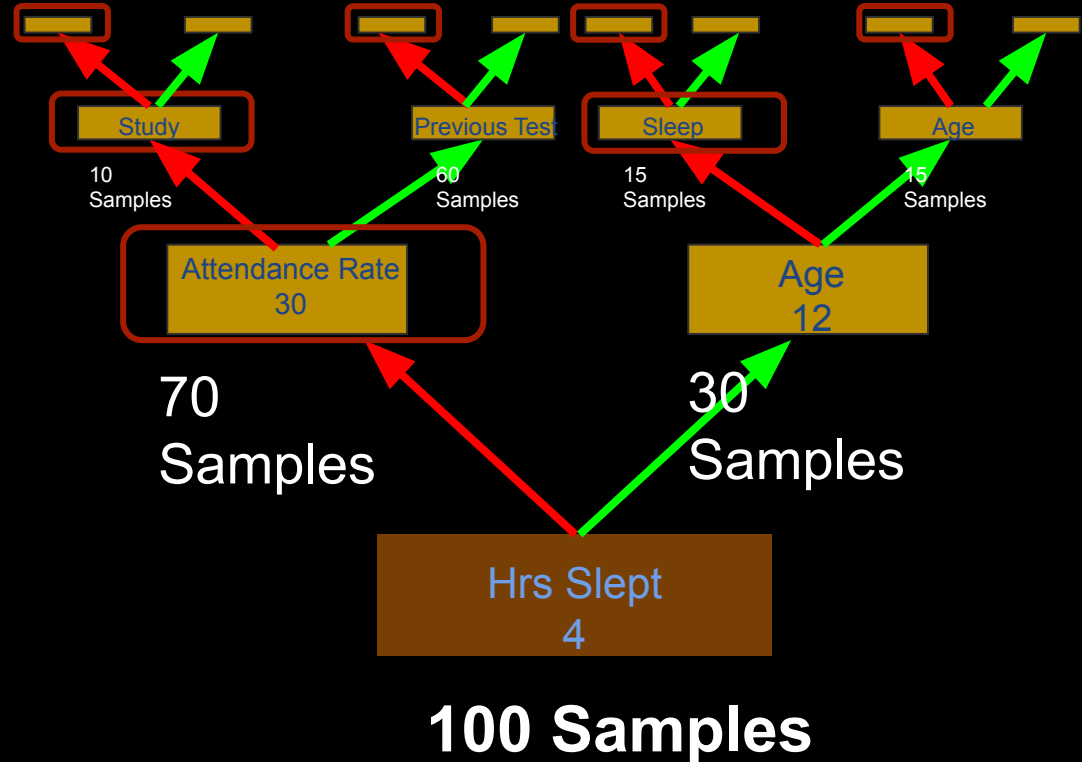
Decision Trees

- **Decision Tree**
- **Root node**
- Child node
- Left node
- Right node
- **Features**
- **Samples**
- **Target Variable**



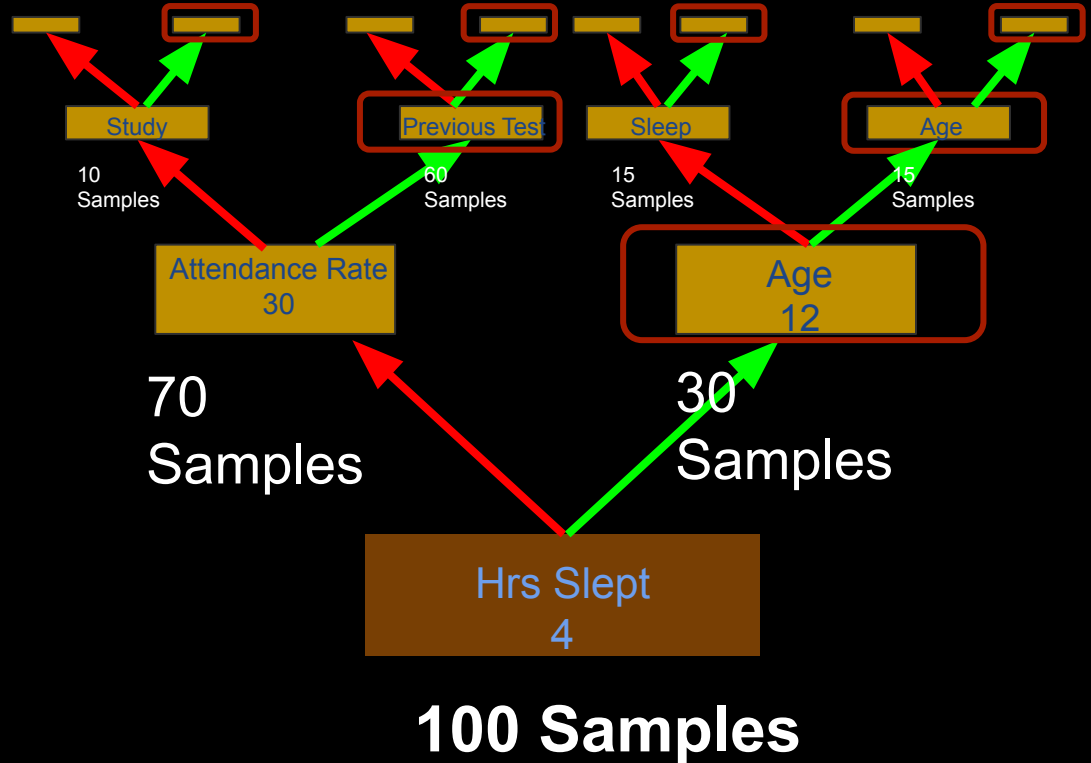
Decision Trees

- **Decision Tree**
- Root node
- Child node
- Left node
- Right node
- **Features**
- **Samples**
- **Target Variable**



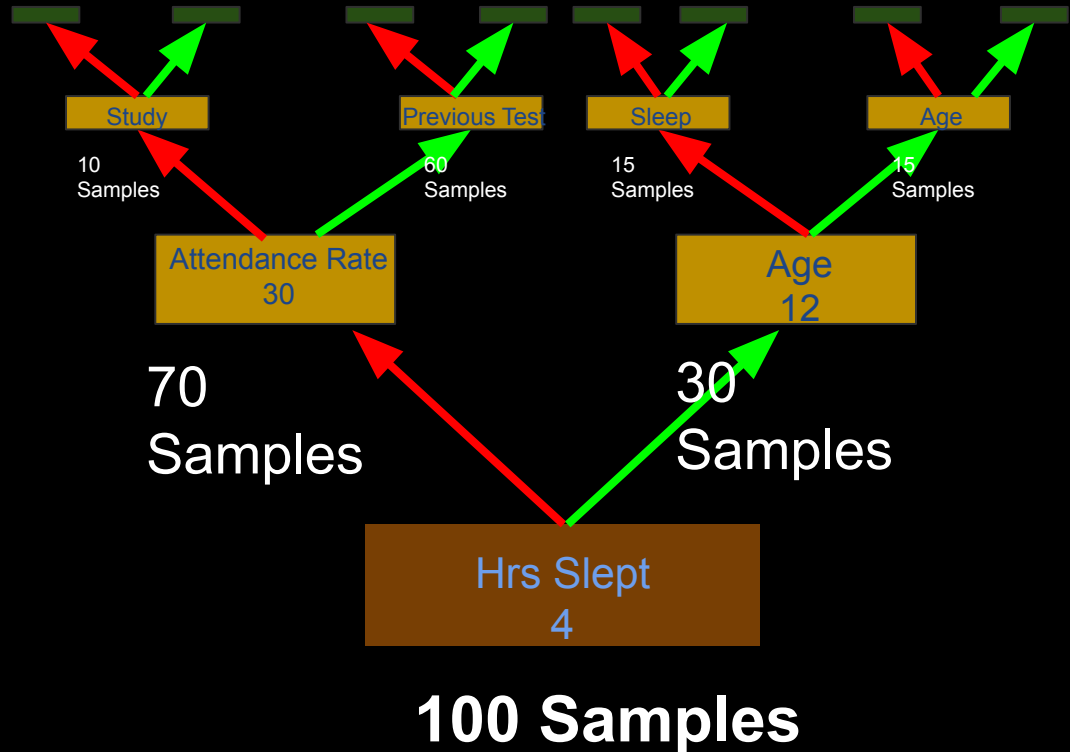
Decision Trees

- **Decision Tree**
- Root node
- Child node
- Left node
- Right node
- **Features**
- **Samples**
- **Target Variable**



Decision Trees

- **Decision Tree**
- Root node
- Child node
- Left node
- Right node
- **Features**
- **Samples**
- **Target Variable**



Experiment



100 Students took a test

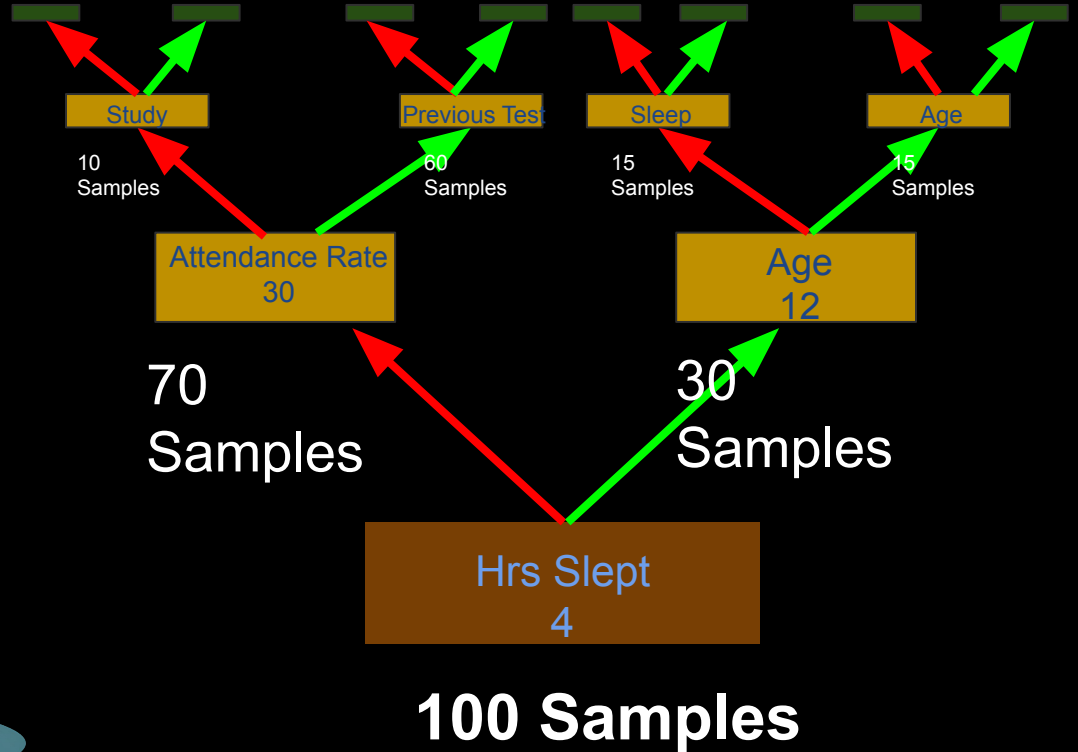
What we know:

- **Hrs studied**
- **Hrs slept**
- **Attendance Rate**
- **Previous Exam Score**
- **Age**
- **Pass/Fail**

What we want to know:

1. Which factor contributes most to whether a student passes?
2. If another student took the test, based on the prior knowledge, will they pass or fail?

Decision Trees



Experiment



100 Students took a test

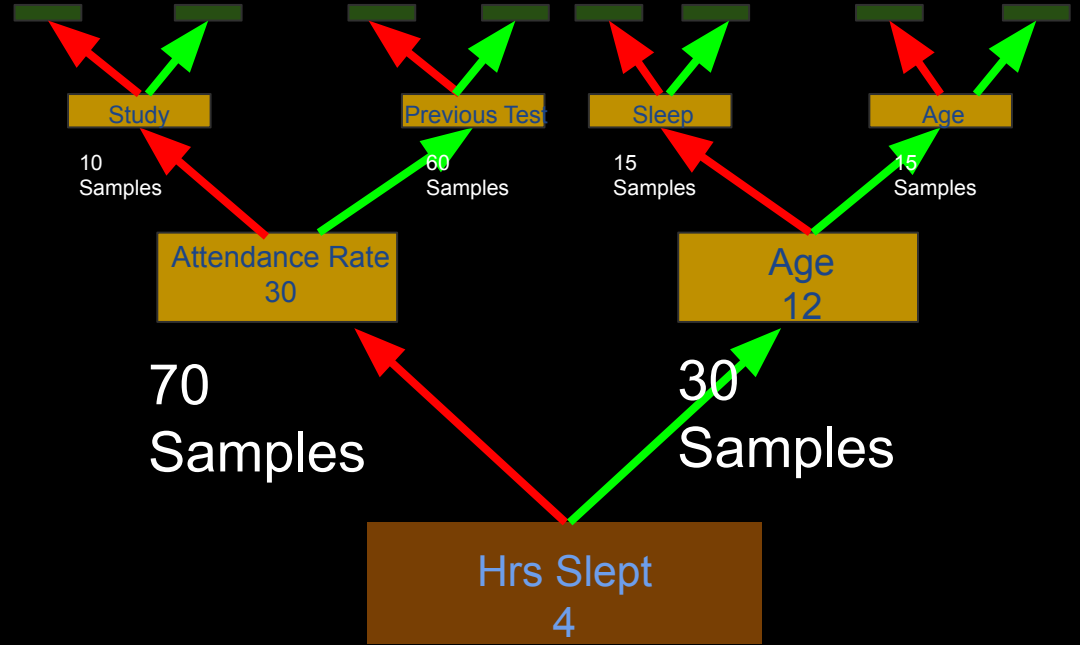
What we know:

- **Hrs studied**
- **Hrs slept**
- **Attendance Rate**
- **Previous Exam Score**
- **Age**
- **Pass/Fail**

What we want to know:

1. Which factor contributes most to whether a student passes?
2. If another student took the test, based on the prior knowledge, will they pass or fail?

Decision Trees



100 Samples

Feature Importance

How well does it split when used to split?

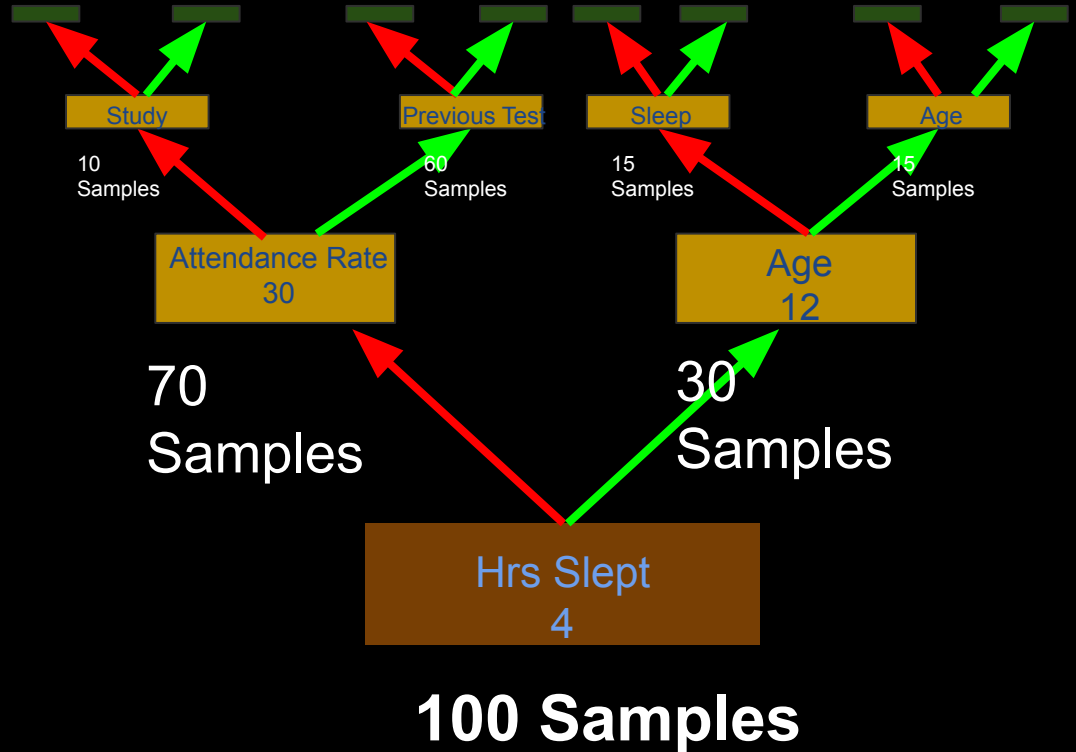
Random Forest

- One tree has bias
- It is normal to use a forest



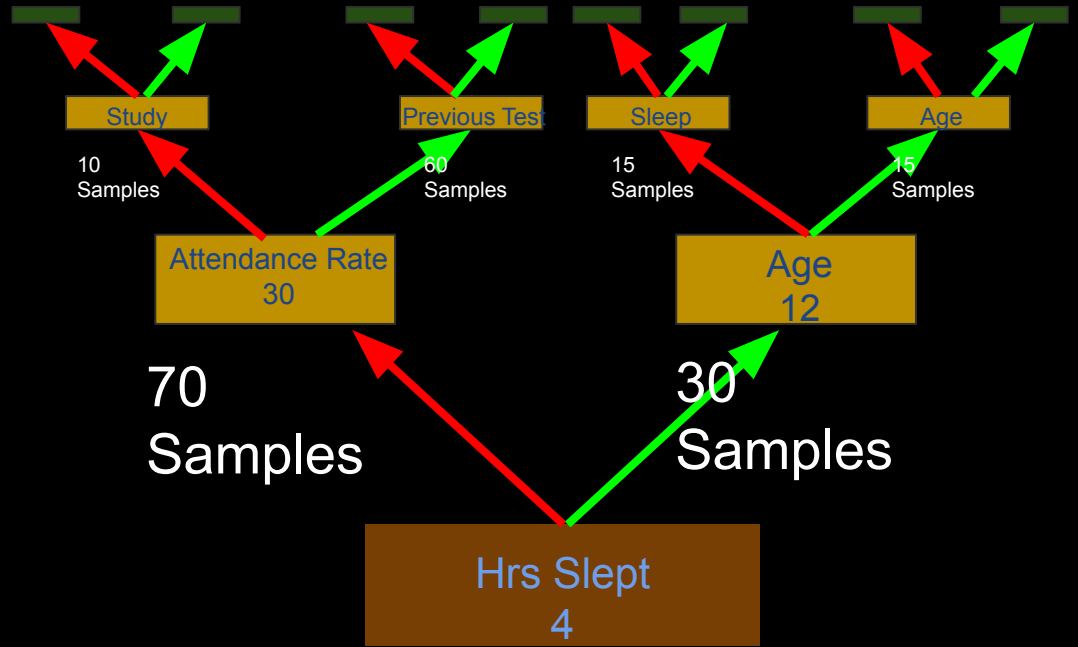
Random Forest

- One tree has bias
- It is normal to use a forest



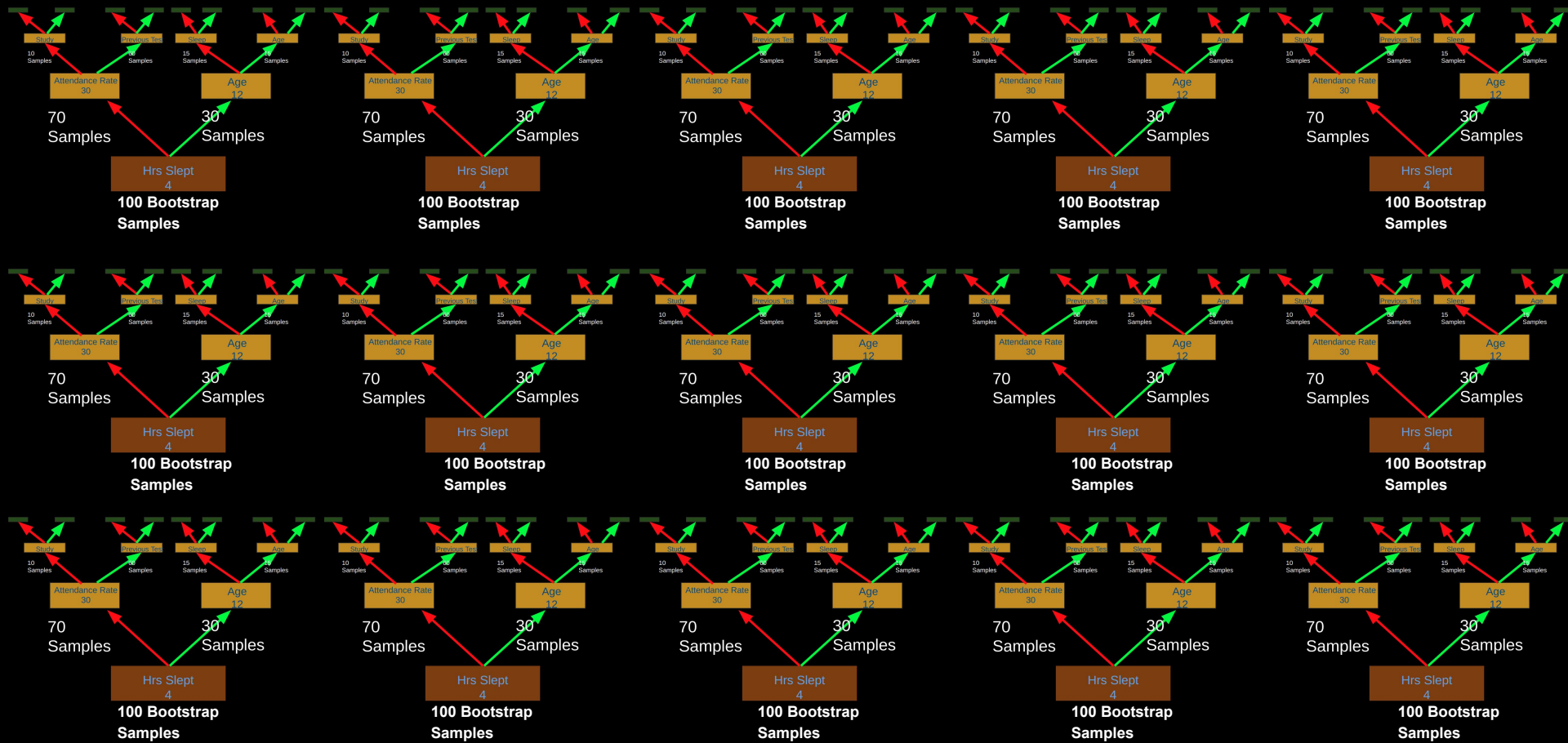
Random Forest

- Lets use 15 Trees
- Bootstrap Sample
 - Size still 100
 - Some values duplicated
 - Some values missing



100 Bootstrap Samples

Random Forest



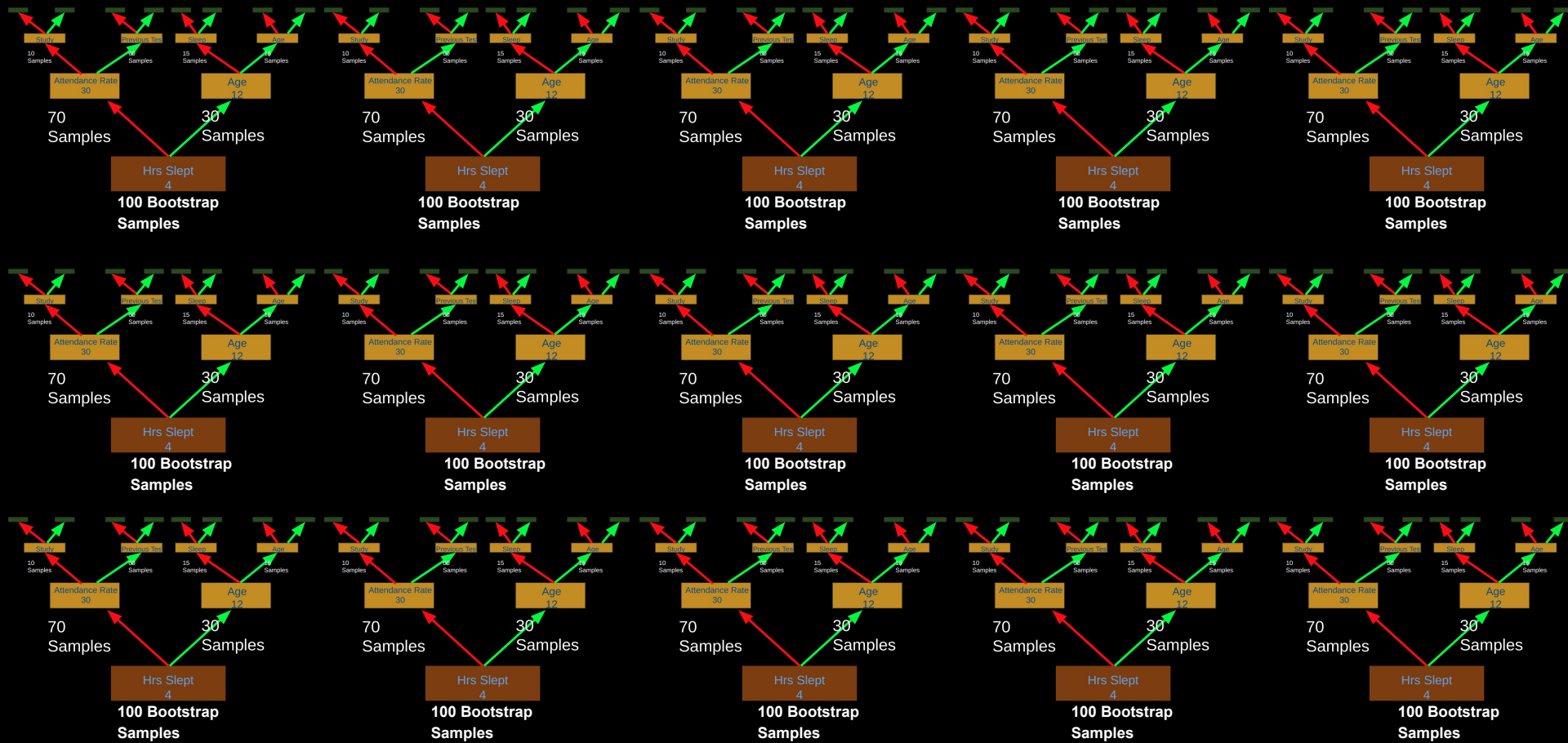
Random Forest



Will they Pass or Fail?

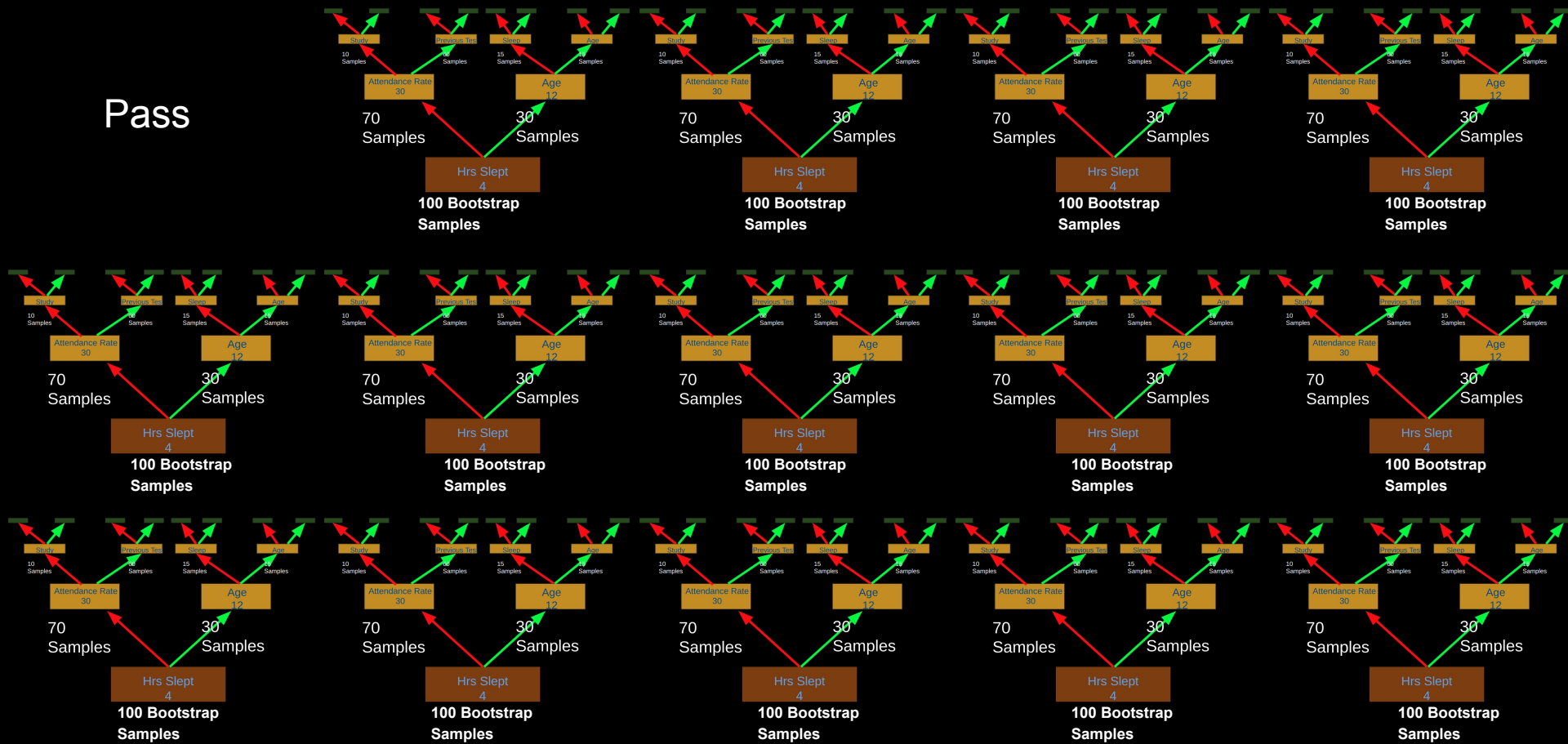


Random Forest



Random Forest

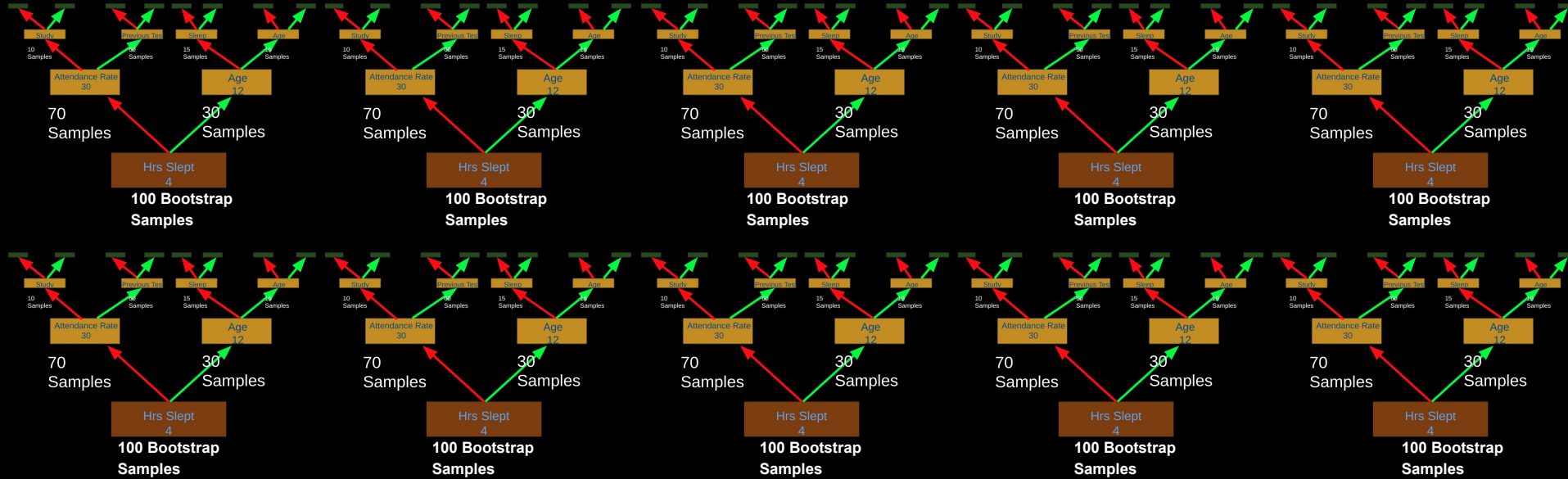
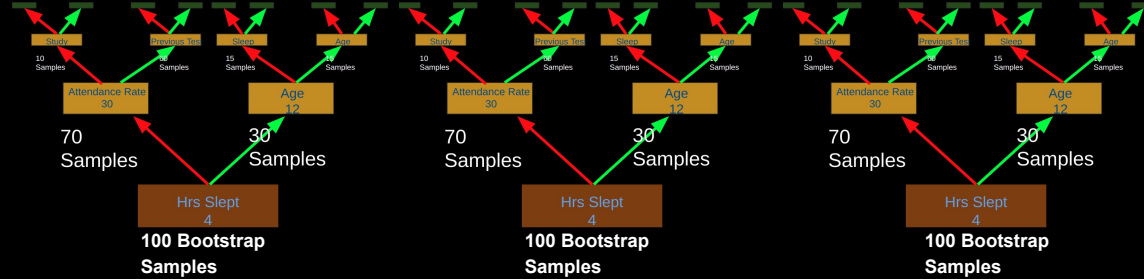
Pass



Random Forest

Pass

Fail

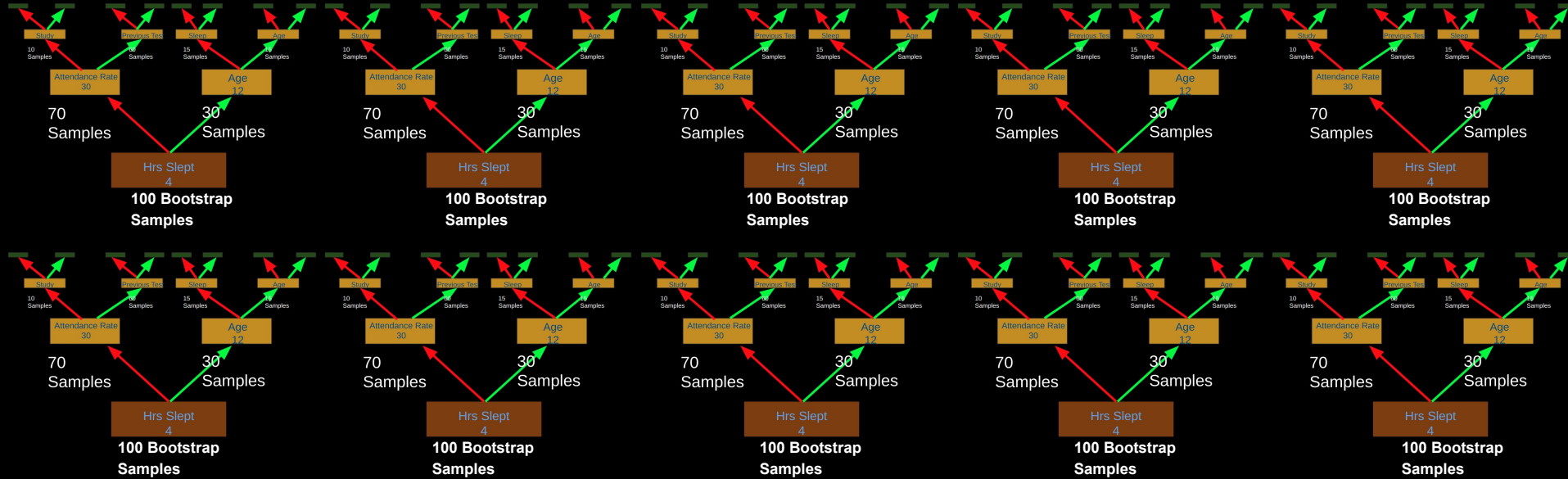
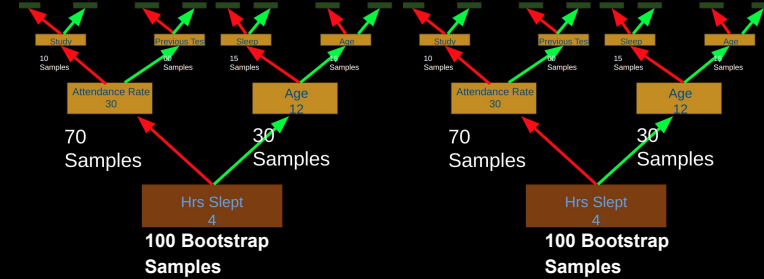


Random Forest

Pass

Fail

Pass



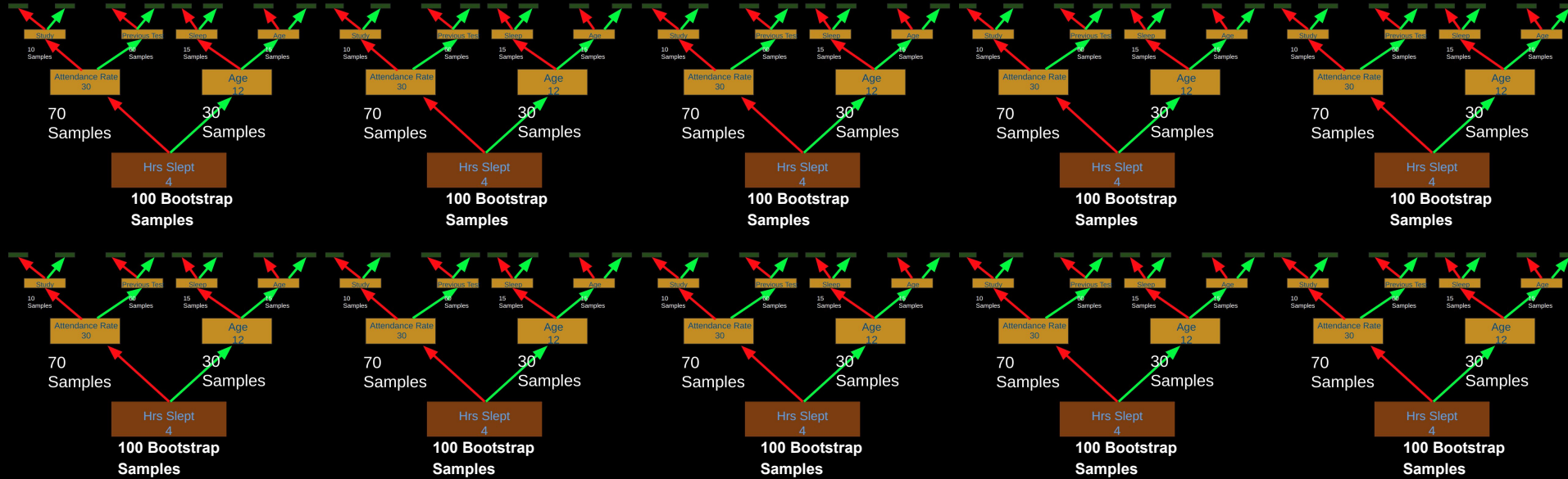
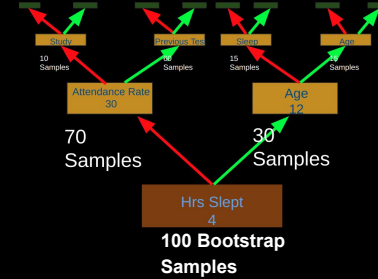
Random Forest

Pass

Fail

Pass

Pass



Random Forest

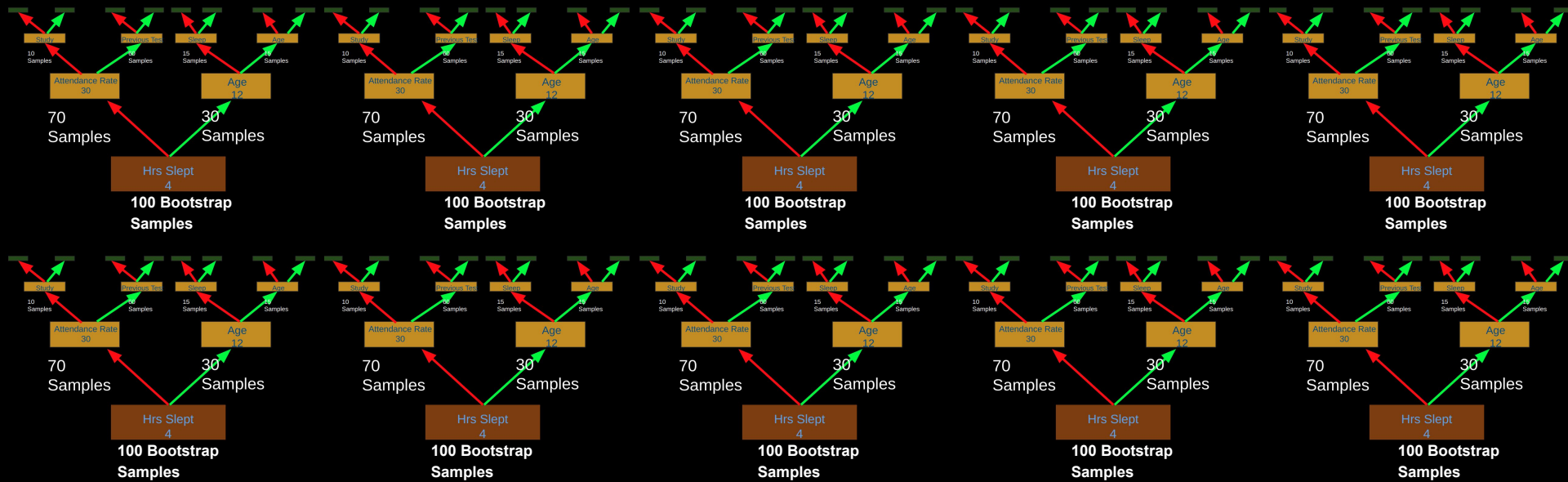
Pass

Fail

Pass

Pass

Pass



Random Forest

Pass

Fail

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Fail

Pass

Random Forest

Pass

Fail

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Pass

Fail

Pass

Experiment



100 Students took a test

What we know:

- **Hrs studied**
- **Hrs slept**
- **Attendance Rate**
- **Previous Exam Score**
- **Age**
- **Pass/Fail**

What we want to know:

1. Which factor contributes most to whether a student passes?
2. If another student took the test, based on the prior knowledge, will they pass or fail?

Experiment



Binary Target
Variable
i.e. True or False

100 Students took a test

What we know:

- Hrs studied
- Hrs slept
- Attendance Rate
- Previous Exam Score
- Age
- Pass/Fail

For a binary target variable
we can use a **Random
Forest Classifier**

Experiment



100 Students took a test

What we know:

- **Hrs studied**
- **Hrs slept**
- **Attendance Rate**
- **Previous Exam Score**
- **Age**
- **Pass/Fail**

What we want to know:

1. Which factor contributes most to whether a student passes?
2. If another student took the test, based on the prior knowledge, will they pass or fail?

Experiment



100 Students took a test

What we know:

- **Hrs studied**
- **Hrs slept**
- **Attendance Rate**
- **Previous Exam Score**
- **Age**
- **Grade**

What we want to know:

1. Which factor contributes most to a student's **grade**?
2. If another student took the test, based on the prior knowledge, what will their **grade** be?

Decision Tree

- **5 Features** Hrs studied, Hrs slept, Attendance Rate, Previous Exam Score, Age
- **Target Variable** Grade
- **100 Samples** Students



Decision Tree

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**



Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Tree

Hrs studied, Hrs slept, Attendance Rate, Previous Exam Score, Age



Root Node

100 Samples

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Decision Tree

Hrs studied, Hrs slept, Attendance Rate, Previous Exam Score, Age



Root Node

100 Samples

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Decision Tree

Loop through Hrs slept, Attendance Rate, Age

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Tree

Hrs slept (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Test each unique
value as a threshold

Root Node

100 Samples

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Decision Tree

Hrs slept (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Threshold

$x < 1$, $x \geq 1$

Left | Right

How well split is the
grade?

Variance of left and right quantifies the goodness of the split

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

Hrs slept (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Threshold

$x < 10$, $x \geq 10$

Left | Right

How well split is the
grade?

Variance of left and right quantifies the goodness
of the split

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

Hrs slept (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Threshold

$x < 6$, $x \geq 6$

Left | Right

How well split is the
grade?

Variance of left and right quantifies the goodness
of the split

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

Hrs slept (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Threshold

$x < 3$, $x \geq 3$

Left | Right

How well split is the
grade?

Variance of left and right quantifies the goodness
of the split

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

Hrs slept (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Threshold

$x < \dots$, $x \geq \dots$

Left | Right

How well split is the
grade?

Variance of left and right quantifies the goodness
of the split

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

Attendance Rate (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Threshold

$x < \dots$, $x \geq \dots$

Left | Right

How well split is the
grade?

Variance of left and right quantifies the goodness
of the split

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

Age (x)

[1, 10, 6, 3 ...]

Threshold

$x < \dots$, $x \geq \dots$

Left | Right

How well split is the
grade?

Variance of left and right quantifies the goodness of the split

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Root Node

100 Samples

Decision Trees

List of Impurity
Reduction Values

Root Node

- Randomly Select a subset of **Features**

Which one is best?

Hrs Slept

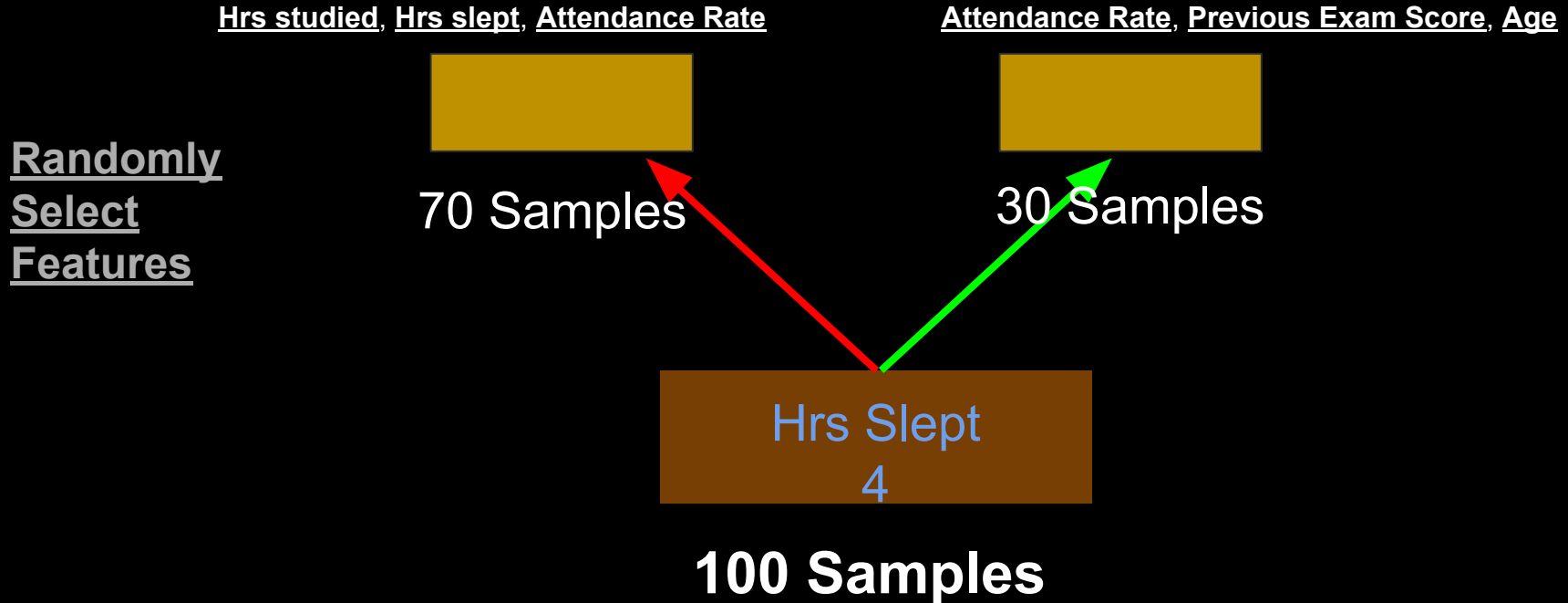
Hrs Slept
4

100 Samples

Decision Trees



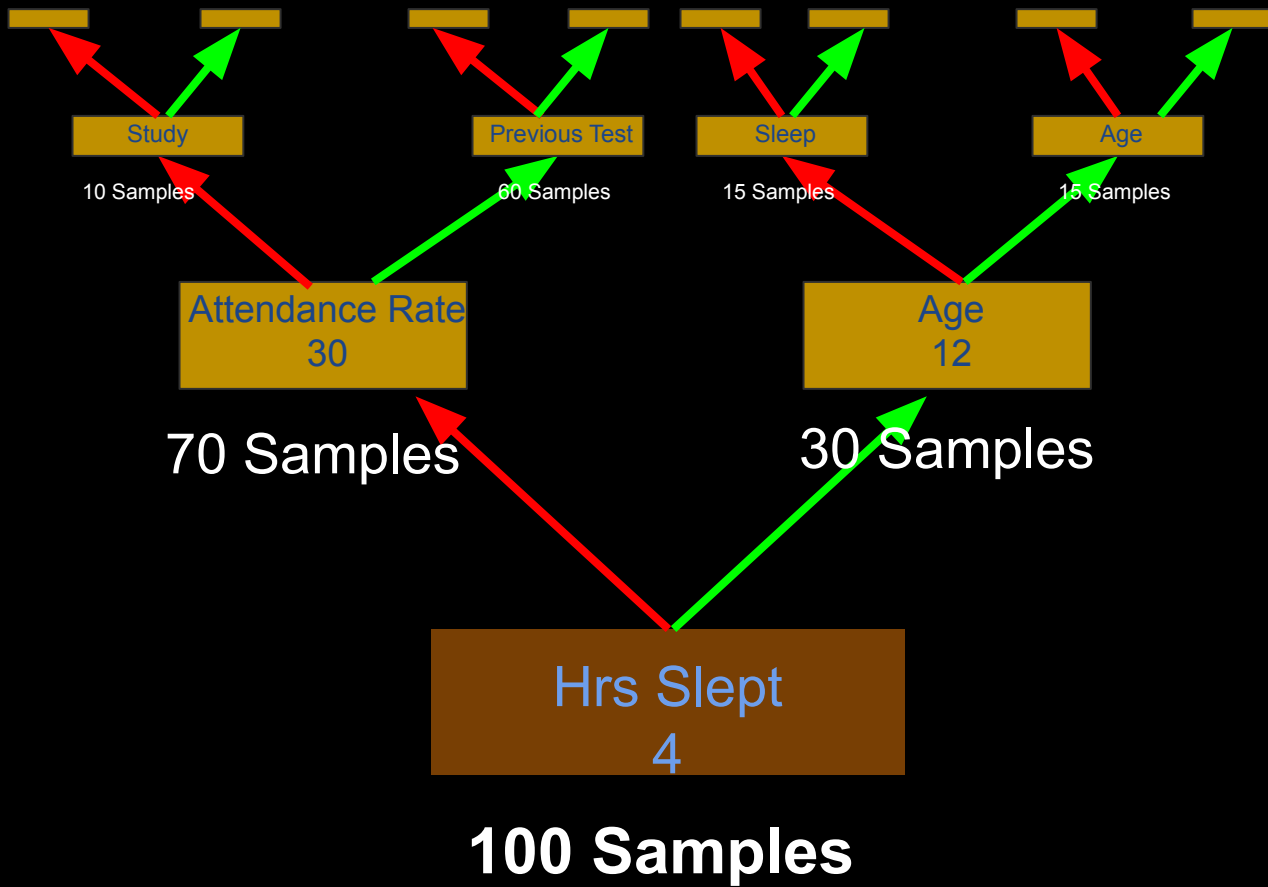
Decision Trees



Decision Trees







Experiment



100 Students took a test

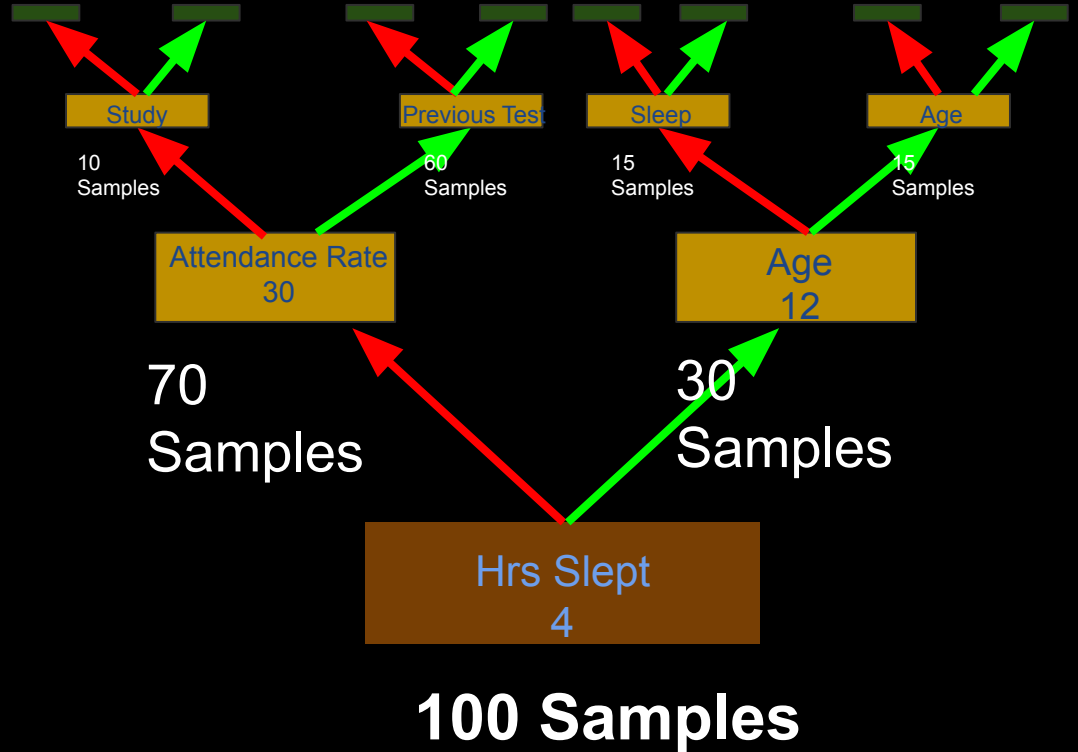
What we know:

- **Hrs studied**
- **Hrs slept**
- **Attendance Rate**
- **Previous Exam Score**
- **Age**
- **Grade**

What we want to know:

1. Which factor contributes most to a student's grade?
2. If another student took the test, based on the prior knowledge, what will their grade be?

Decision Trees



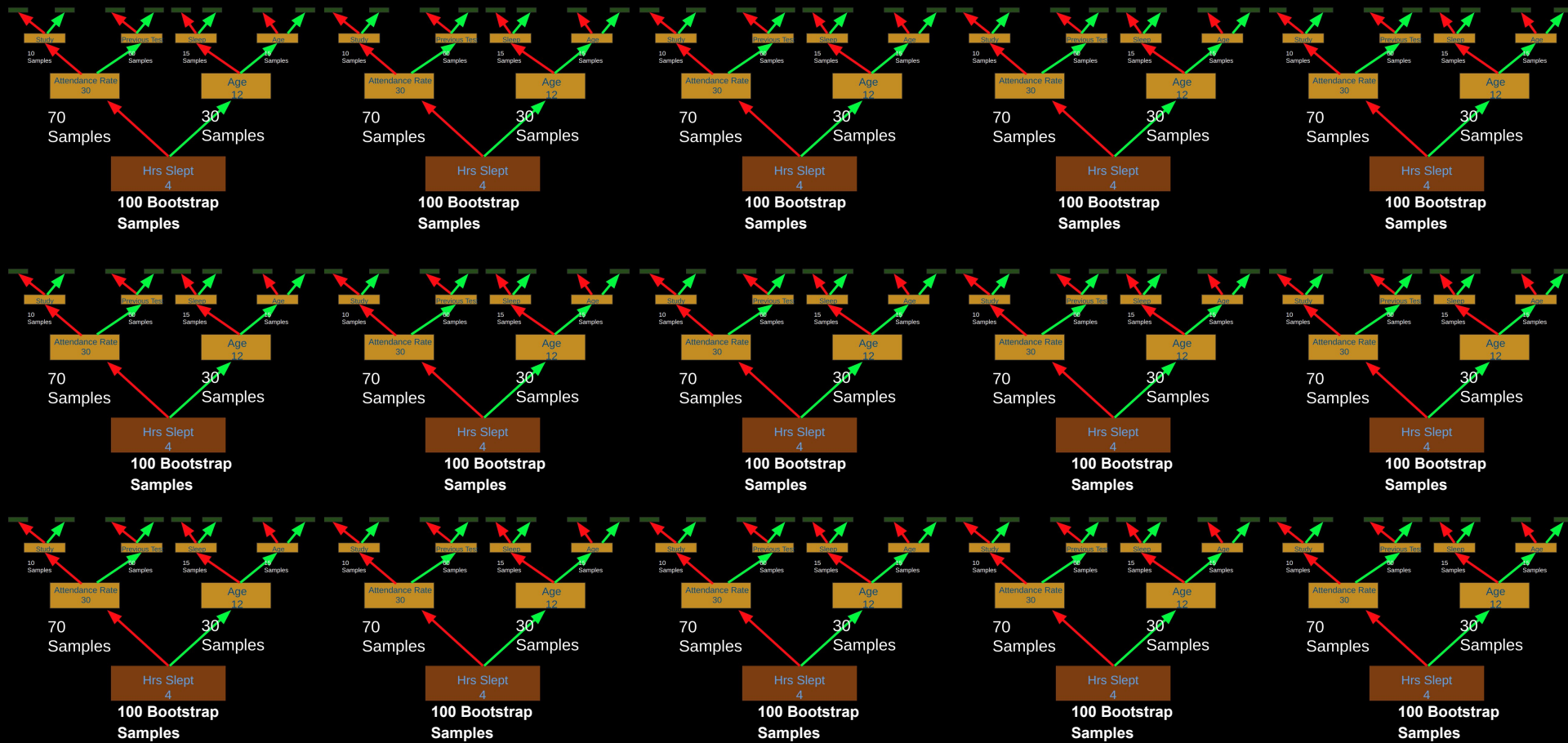
Decision Trees



70/100

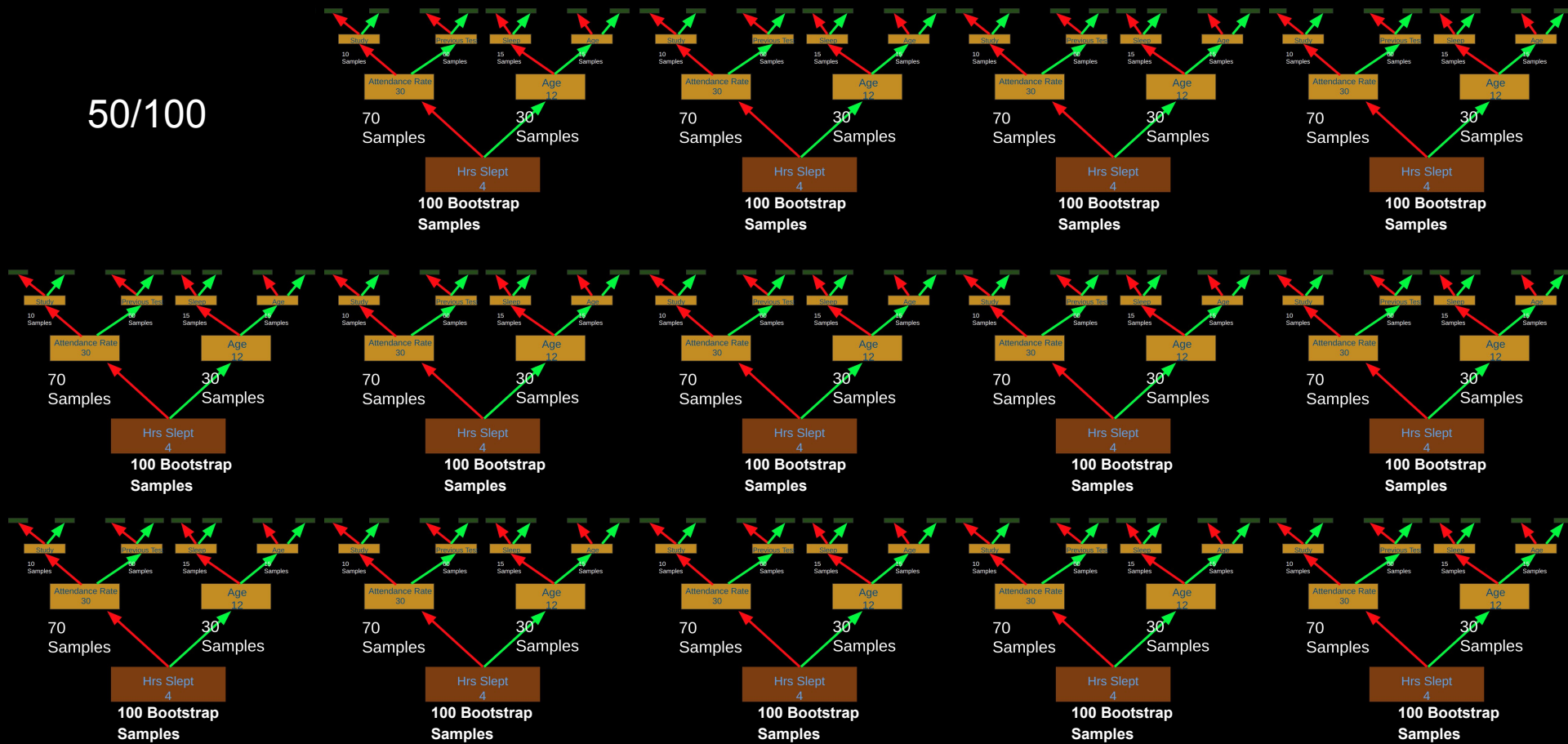


Random Forest



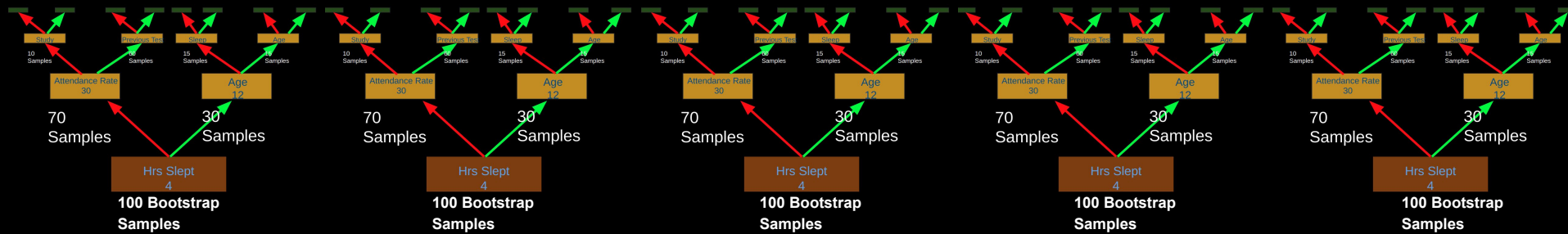
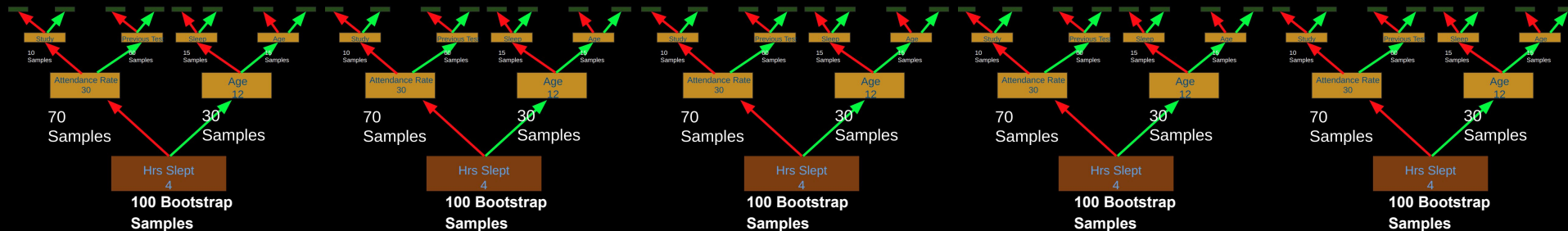
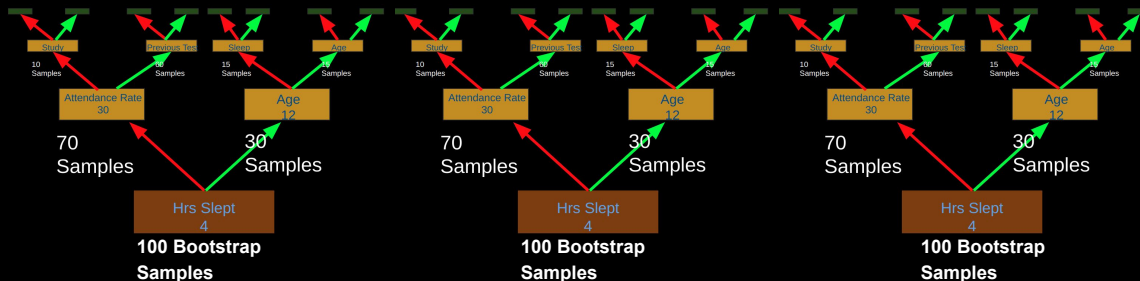
Random Forest

50/100



Random Forest

50/100

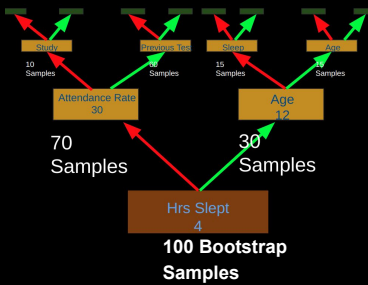
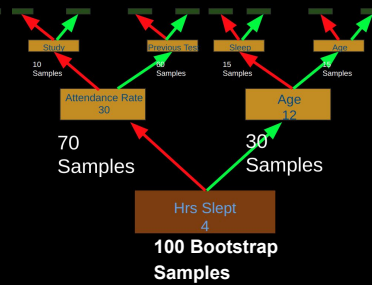
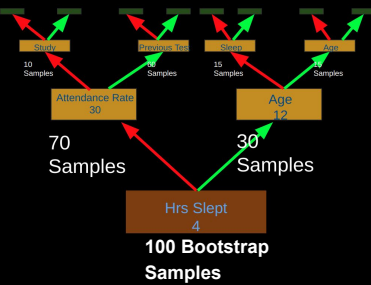
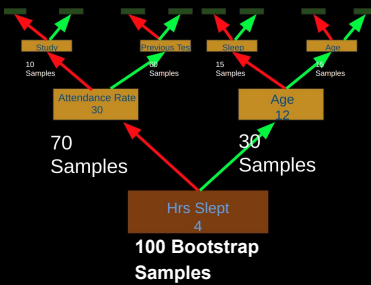
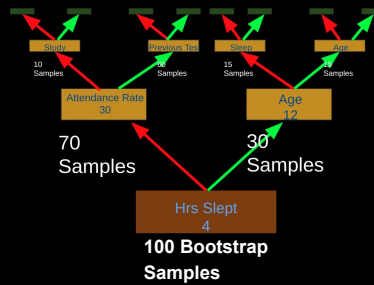
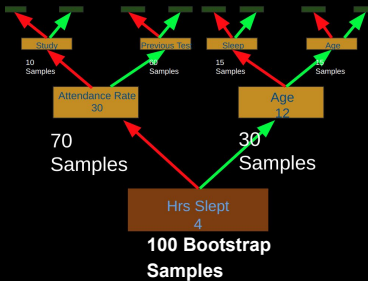
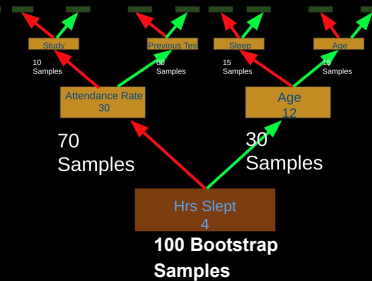
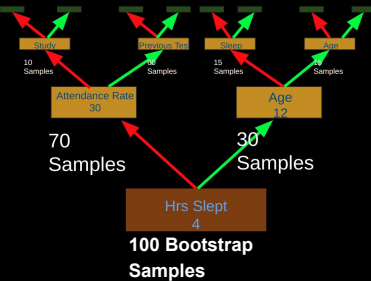
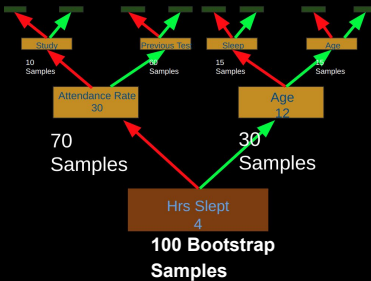
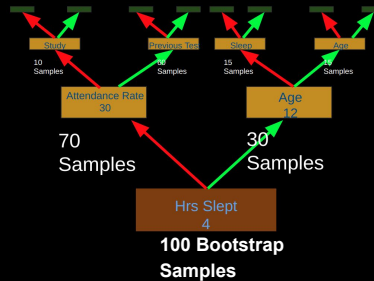
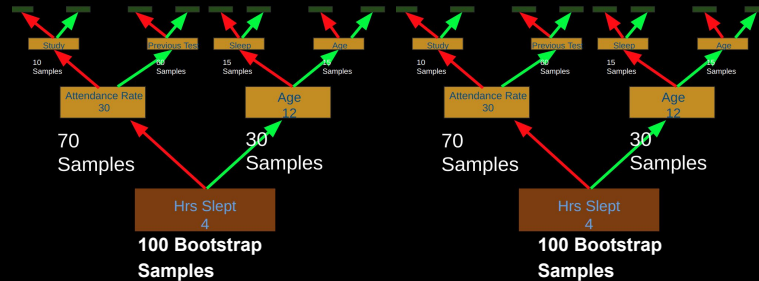


Random Forest

50/100

90/100

20/100



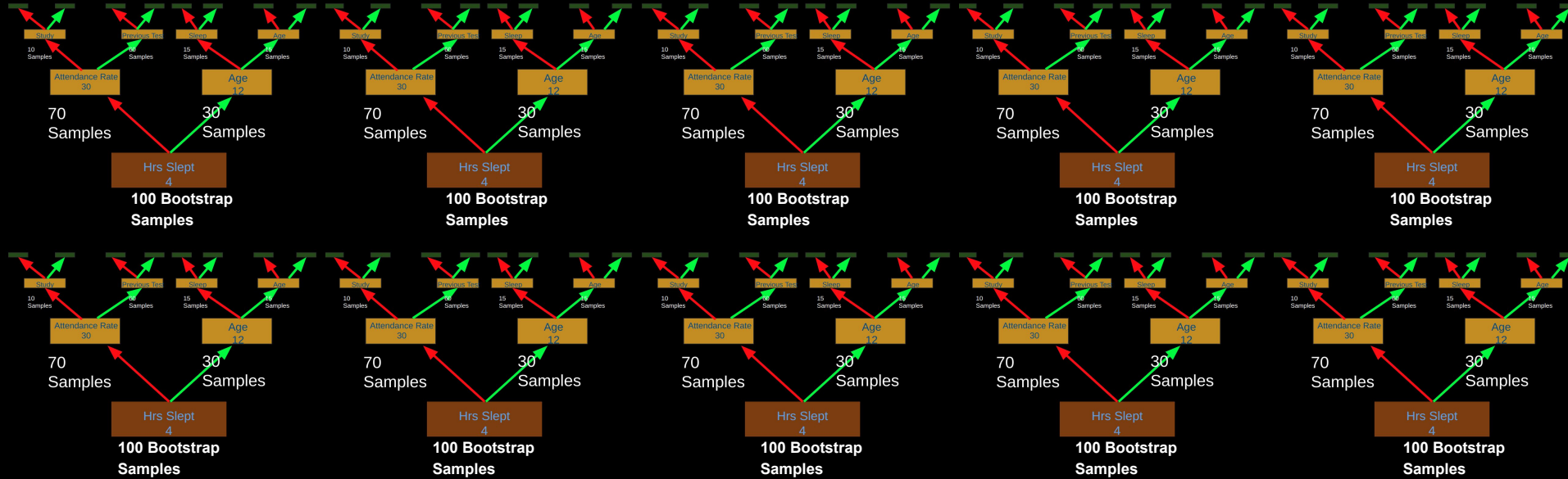
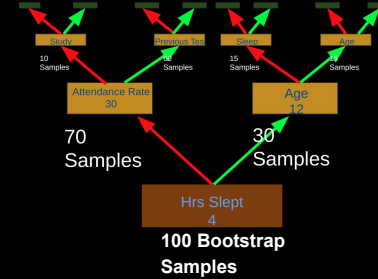
Random Forest

50/100

90/100

20/100

30/100



Random Forest

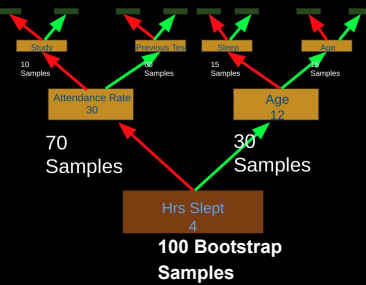
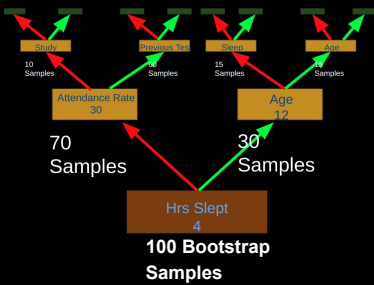
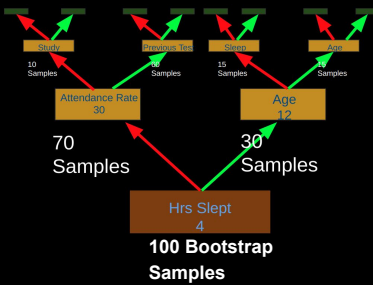
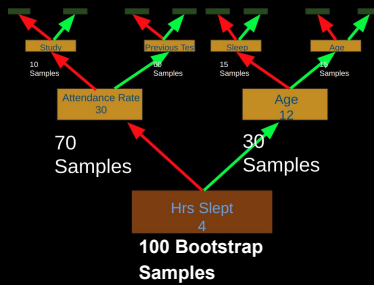
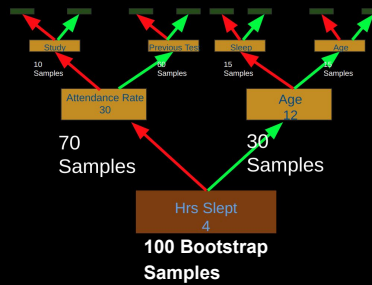
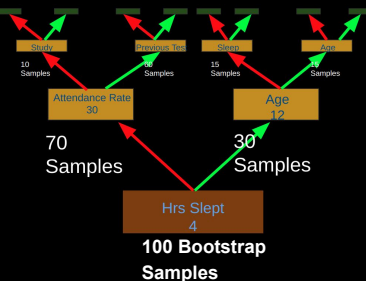
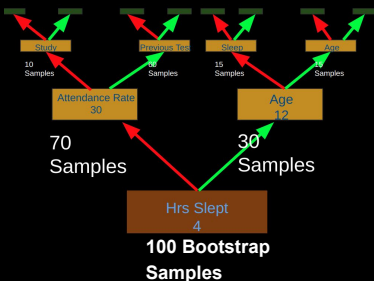
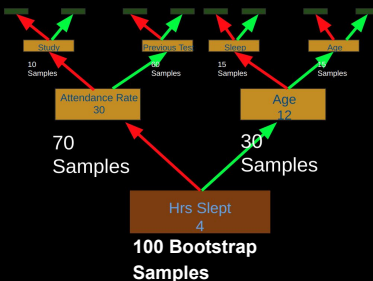
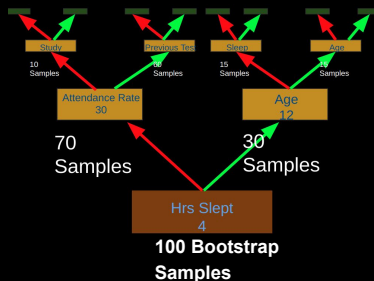
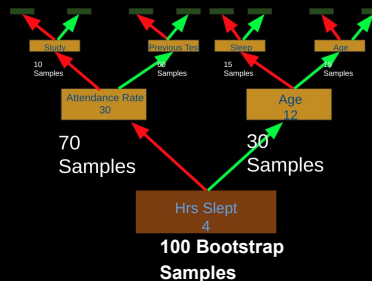
50/100

90/100

20/100

30/100

51/100



Random Forest

50/100

90/100

20/100

30/100

51/100

55/100

63/100

58/100

70/100

60/100

64/100

62/100

65/100

99/100

58/100

Decision Trees



[50, 90, 20, 30, 51, 55, 63,
58, 70, 60, 64, 62, 65, 99,
58]



Decision Trees



Mean: 60/100



Experiment



100 Students took a test

What we know:

- **Hrs studied**
- **Hrs slept**
- **Attendance Rate**
- **Previous Exam Score**
- **Age**
- **Grade**

What we want to know:

1. Which factor contributes most to a student's grade?
2. If another student took the test, based on the prior knowledge, what will their grade be?

Decision Trees



Feature Importance

How well does it split when used to split?



Experiment



100 Students took a test

What we know:

- **Hrs studied**
- **Hrs slept**
- **Attendance Rate**
- **Previous Exam Score**
- **Age**
- **Grade**

What we want to know:

1. Which factor contributes most to a student's grade?
2. If another student took the test, based on the prior knowledge, what will their grade be?

Experiment



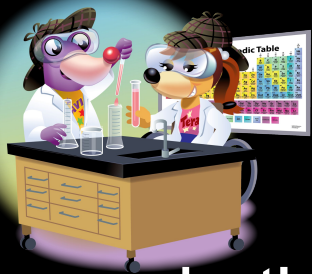
Continuous
Target Variable
i.e. True or False

100 Students took a test

What we know:

- Hrs studied
- Hrs slept
- Attendance Rate
- Previous Exam Score
- Age
- Grade

For a continuous target variable we can use a
Random Forest Regressor



Let's do some coding!

Feature

